小春雀儿
Eagle

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绅士俱乐部
Boys Only FX-01

字母的研究
Finding Xavier

绅士俱乐部
Boys Only

日光，从清晨敞开、用以通风的窗口流畅地穿过，淌向正前方那个盛满荣耀的展示柜。
The morning sun falls through the window and onto the display cabinet.

里面收藏的每一枚徽章都闪闪发亮，排列如同整装待发的小锡兵。
The badges stand in line, upright, like little toy soldiers.

紧绷，坚定，朝气蓬勃。一幕童子军箴言的写照。
Just like the Scout motto says, "Be prepared!"

教官：……总而言之……
Scout Leader: ... In a word—

教官：这不符合规定。
Scout Leader: It's against the rules.

“小锡兵”们当然对那些视线习以为常。
The child standing before the Scout leader doesn't respond. She's enraptured by the badges—the representation of a Scout's honor.

视线，或者说眼神。
所有踏进这房间的小孩子，都会投向那些闪亮徽章的渴盼眼神。
Every child who enters this room is attracted to them, but none more so than Eagle.

——恰如此刻。
Her eyes are glued, sparkling with eagerness.

小春雀儿：……
Eagle: ...

教官：你在听我说话吗?
Scout Leader: Are you listening?

小春雀儿：！抱……抱歉！我……
Eagle: S-sorry, sir, I ...

小春雀儿：对不起，我没有听清楚。
Eagle: I didn't catch that.

教官：我说，破格允许一个女孩加入童子军，这不符合规定。
Scout Leader: I said that girls aren't allowed to join the Scouts. It's against the rules.

教官：你回去吧。
Scout Leader: Go home, kid.

小春雀儿：但是，也许您在看过我的技能展示之后会改变主意。这次，我准备得很充分——
Eagle: Please, just let me show my skills. Maybe then you'll change your mind. I've been working so hard and—

教官：停下。你不用上前来。
Scout Leader: No need to step forward.

小春雀儿：好的，长官。
Eagle: Yes, sir.

教官：听好了，孩子。我们没有开过这样的先例，以后也不会有。
Scout Leader: Listen, kid, no girl has ever joined the Scouts, and no girl will ever join the Scouts.

教官：让我看看——上个月，十天前。你可是真是“执着”……报名处的人难道没跟你说清楚吗?
Scout Leader: Let me see ... You applied 10 days ago, and a month ago, too. Didn't they tell you back then that girls weren't allowed?

小春雀儿：不，没有，长官。他说得很清楚……
Eagle: Yes, sir, they did ...

教官：那么看来问题还是出在你自己身上。就像你刚才的“神游天外”……
Scout Leader: Well, then it seems you're the problem. You don't remember what people tell you.

教官：从这点来看，你似乎还有一定的注意力缺陷。这也与我们所需要的童子军素养差之甚远。
Scout Leader: You've got a short attention span—maybe even some kind of attention deficit. I'm afraid that doesn't meet the Scout's standards.

一次失误，似乎酿成了无解的苦果。
Eagle didn't expect such a simple mistake to lead to such irreparable consequences.

小春雀儿：可您还没有看过我的生存技能展示——
Eagle: But sir, you haven't seen my survival skills presentation—

女孩下意识想要解释，走到舌苔的话语却被一个抬手的动作简单截断。
She won't let this chance slip away from her like this. Not again.

教官：没有必要了。
Scout Leader: I don't need to.

教官：看看你的身后吧，还有其他人在等着呢。“帮助他人”，记得吗?
Scout Leader: Look behind you. There's a whole line of people waiting to speak to me. A Scout must always "help others," remember?

等待着进行技能展示的男孩都在她身后不远处排成整齐的长队。他们列队伫立墙边，但好奇的目光都不约而同地投向房间中央。
She doesn't need to turn back to know that there's an orderly line of boys behind her, each with their eyes fixed on her.

小春雀儿回过头，垂眼时把哽咽吞下，令走到舌尖的反对变成了一句顺应的箴言。
She lowers her eyes and obediently recites the section of the Scout Oath.

小春雀儿：……“随时帮助他人，做一个健康且正直的人。”
Eagle: "... help other people at all times ..."

教官：没错。如果你真的想成为一名光荣的童子军，那就应该从这些细节做起。
Scout Leader: Exactly. If you really want to be a Scout, you should start acting like one.

小春雀儿：但是长官……!
Eagle: But sir—

教官：看，你甚至没办法服从这么简单的命令。
Scout Leader: You're also forgetting another law: "A Scout obeys orders." Something you're failing to do right now.

小春雀儿：……
Eagle: ...

小春雀儿：我明白了。
Eagle: Understood ...

小春雀儿：抱歉，长官。
Eagle: Sorry, sir.

小春雀儿：没关系，没关系……
Eagle: It's okay, it's okay ...

她小声地为自己打气，充任着不存在的鼓励者角色。
She whispers to herself, playing as her own comforter.

小春雀儿：父亲，会怎么做呢。
Eagle: What would Father do if he was rejected?

???: ……任务……失踪……
???: ... Mission ... Find the missing ...

???: ……化工厂……
???: ... Chemical plant ...

一阵人声。几个依稀可辨的关键词。
Fragments of a conversation drift through the partially opened door ahead.

小春雀儿停住脚步，就连呼吸也下意识一并放轻。
Eagle halts, subconsciously holding her breath to better hear it.

声音，来自侧前方一扇虚掩的门内，在几近无人的走廊上逐渐震耳欲聋。
As she carefully draws nearer to the source, the voice becomes clearer.

教官：——名字叫泽维尔（Xavier）。
Scout Leader: His name is Xavier.

教官：我再说一遍。泽维尔最后一次被目击的地点，在化工厂附近。你们的下一个任务，就是找到并带回泽维尔。
Scout Leader: I repeat, Xavier was last seen near the chemical plant. Your next mission is to find Xavier and take him back.

《童子军手册》素养篇 III：迅速敏锐，善抓机会。
Scout Manual, Essential Virtues, Article III: "Be acute and seize opportunities."

小春雀儿：……?!
Eagle: ...!

TO BE CONTINUED…
TO BE CONTINUED...

见习侦探
Young Detective FX-02

见习侦探
Young Detective

空旷的工厂内，一行衣着整洁的家伙来到了这满是灰尘的地界。
The worn-down factory welcomes a pair of neatly dressed visitors.

无视了正在作业的其他人，他们走向一处器械旁的空地。
Ignoring the workers and their looks, they walk over to an open space by a machine.

调查员：就是这里。
Investigator: Here we are.

调查员：请小心脚下。
Investigator: Please watch your step.

???: 一个钢筋铁骨的垃圾厂。所以，我们究竟要做什么?
???: A factory filled with a load of run-down machinery. So, what's our mission?

调查员: 主要是利用经过神秘术处理的净化工具，改造这间化工厂的整体环境。
Investigator: To improve the environment here. You need to cleanse this chemical plant with the arcane purification equipment provided.

调查员: 并在改造完成后，进行可行性测试，保证工具能够持续正常运作。
Investigator: When you're done, you should perform a feasibility test to make sure all the machines are functioning properly.

???: 我一个人？做完这些？所有事?
???: Me? Do the whole thing?

调查员: 我们相信你有这个能力。
Investigator: We believe you're competent enough to do so.

调查员: 在你的准备期间，我们还会负责疏散工厂内人群，在周围散开迷障网，确保你不仅不会被打扰，而且不会造成任何人员伤亡。
Investigator: While you prepare, we'll evacuate the workers and put up a Maze Net to ensure no one is injured or disturbs you.

调查员: 所有的准备都是为了保障安全，且为你提供一个安静的作业环境。如你所愿。
Investigator: We'll make sure you have a safe and undisturbed working environment, as you stipulated.

???: 那还真是受宠若惊啊，哈哈。
???: Haha. I'm flattered.

???: 说起来，你们难道都没有闻到一股脂肪燃烧的味道吗?
???: By the way, do you smell something funny, like burning fat?

调查员: 没有，而且这不应该。
Investigator: No. This place shouldn't have any fat.

调查员: 之前踩点时，我们已经投放了符合规定数量的臭臭泥自走清洁球……
Investigator: But when we scouted out the site, we did deploy a number of Stinky Walking Cleaning Balls.

???: 原来是这个。很好，这下闻起来像穿了十个月没洗的臭袜子了。
???: Ah, that must be it. Well, now it smells like stinky socks. Yikes.

???: 算了……再说说看，这都是怎么回事来着?
???: Anyway ... Remind me again what we're doing here?

调查员: 利用净化工具，改造这间化工厂的整体环境，然后进行可行性测试。
Investigator: Cleansing this chemical plant and performing a feasibility test.

调查员: 这些需求都是根据基金会与一批内生污染严重的化工厂达成的协议来制定的。
Investigator: These measures are part of an agreement made between the Foundation and a number of severely polluted chemical plants.

调查员: 稍后还会有拉普拉斯的其他专业人员过来协助你。
Investigator: More Laplace staff members will come to assist you later.

???: ……
???: ...

???: 麻烦让他们快点——
???: Please ask them to hurry.

???: 和最新款的防毒面罩一起过来，行吗?
???: Also, ask them to bring the latest gas masks, will you?

《童子军手册》安全篇 VI：行动前，请仔细评估目标周围环境。
Scout Manual, Safety, Article VI: "Always assess the surroundings before taking action."

简单的追踪术，出色的隐匿技巧。凭借这些，小春雀儿成功跟上童子军小队的脚步——
With her excellent tracking and concealment skills, Eagle follows the Scout team to the destination of their mission—

一座位于郊区的化工厂。
A chemical plant in the suburbs.

穿梭在被疏散离开的工厂职员之间，在恰到好处的距离之外，她仔细地观察着落在小队最后的两人。
Amid the employees evacuating the factory, she watches the two members at the back of the Scout team from a distance.

小春雀儿: 他们在……原地待命。
Eagle: They're ... staying behind.

小春雀儿: 有些听不清楚，还需要再走近一些吗……
Eagle: I can't hear them from here ... Should I get closer?

皮鞋小心翼翼地向前踱步。
She carefully closes the distance, keeping to the shadows to hide herself.

小春雀儿: 嗯，能听清楚了。
Eagle: Alright, now I can hear them.

童子军 I: ——泽维尔居然跑来这种地方，确实需要很大的勇气。
Boy Scout I: This place gives me the creeps. Xavier must be really brave to come here!

童子军 I: 我就知道刚才麦克说的没错!
Boy Scout I: Mike was right. His secret mission must be a tough one!

童子军 II: 那个“泽维尔来这里是为了完成一项艰巨的机密任务，所以才两天没有回家”的说法?
Boy Scout II: What? You really think he hasn't been home for two days because of some secret mission?

童子军 II: 我甚至不愿意叫它“推理”，因为这明显是对侦探技巧的侮辱……
Boy Scout II: Mike isn't a detective, you know. He's just making stuff up!

小春雀儿: “机密任务”……
Eagle: "Secret mission" ...

童子军 II: ……我还是觉得，这就是，呃，“拐带”。
Boy Scout II: I still think this is—um, what's the word? A "kidnapping."

童子军 I: 哼，这你就不明白了。
Boy Scout I: Humph, you're so wrong.

童子军 I: 大人们总以为，乖宝宝离家出走，一定是被拐带了。要是时间再稍微长了些，那肯定就是失踪了。
Boy Scout I: Adults always think that if a good boy runs away from home, he must've been kidnapped.

童子军 I: 我不这么想。说不定，泽维尔来这里，真的是为了什么秘密任务呢?
Boy Scout I: But I don't think so! I think Xavier came here for a secret mission!

童子军 Ⅰ： 成功挫败了废弃工厂中的惊天阴谋之类的……就像都市传奇故事！那些漫画书上的玩意儿，你懂吧?

Boy Scout I: To break up a huuuuge evil plan being hatched in an abandoned factory, like in the comic books, you know?

童子军 Ⅱ： 你不会是认真的吧……

Boy Scout II: You can't be serious.

童子军 Ⅱ： 比起这些，我觉得更要紧的是，在这里待上超过一天，所有人的鼻子都会坏掉。

Boy Scout II: If anything breaks, it'll be our noses. This place stinks!

童子军 Ⅱ： 哈……啊嚏！

Boy Scout II: Achoo!

小春雀儿： ……环境异常。

Eagle: Something's wrong with the environment here.

童子军 Ⅰ： 可找到泽维尔的人能直接升级为小队长！相比起来，这点代价简直不算什么——

Boy Scout I: Sure does, but whoever finds Xavier will be promoted to team leader! I'll keep searching, even if my nose falls off!

小春雀儿： ……！

Eagle: ...!

童子军 Ⅰ： 我相信，今天就是我成为小队长的机会！

Boy Scout I: Today's the day I become a team leader! I can feel it!

童子军 Ⅱ： 好吧……那如果你想当小队长，怎么不走到前面去？走在最后，说不定就会被傻瓜乔治抢先了。

Boy Scout II: Then why don't you go to the front of the team? That dummy George might find him first if you don't.

童子军 Ⅱ： 之前的义卖活动里，你们可拿了数量差不多的勋章……

Boy Scout II: He did win the same number of badges as you for the charity sale.

童子军 Ⅰ： 嘿！你以为我想落在后面吗？我这是在保护你！而且，你瞧好了，待会儿我肯定有办法。

Boy Scout I: Hey, I'm staying here to protect you! And just you wait, I'll figure out a way to beat him!

童子军 Ⅱ： 唉，随便你吧。我们是不是一直在绕路?

Boy Scout II: Whatever you say ... I think we've circled back on ourselves now.

童子军 Ⅰ： 我还觉得奇怪呢……走，去前面问问。

Boy Scout I: I think you're right. Let's catch up with the others.

男孩们私语着远去。

The boys walk away, still deep in conversation.

小春雀儿从隐蔽处走出来。属于神秘术的淡色线条自怀表上缓慢延伸，如同一根满载求知欲的触肢。

Eagle emerges from her hiding place, holding the pocket watch hung around her neck. The light of her arcane skill extends from the watch.

——去往与男孩们相反的方向。

It points in the opposite direction to the boys'.

小春雀儿： 他们走了，我也得赶紧——

Eagle: They've left. I better hurry too.

她停住了脚步。毛躁并不属于童子军的任何品质之一。

Eagle stops herself. Don't rush into things—that's what she learned from the manual.

整理衣襟，束紧领结，像是一位亟待接受任务的、真正的童子军。
She takes a deep breath, straightens her bow, and starts forming a mission brief, like a real Scout would do.

小春雀儿：“失踪者名叫泽维尔，年龄……在 7 至 18 岁之间，与家长住在一起。最后被目击的地点在化工厂附近。”
Eagle: Name: Xavier, Sex: male, Age: between 7 and 18 years. Lives with his parents. Last seen around the chemical plant.

小春雀儿：……失踪者也许有秘密任务。
Eagle: May be on a secret mission.

小春雀儿：找到失踪者的人，可以直接晋升为童子军小队队长。
Eagle: Whoever finds the missing person will be promoted to team leader of the Scouts team.

小春雀儿：……
Eagle: ...

小春雀儿：如果他们找到泽维尔，就能破格直接晋升……那我，是不是也有机会呢?
Eagle: Whoever finds Xavier will be promoted ... Then if I find him, will I have a chance, too?

小春雀儿：破格加入童子军的机会。
Eagle: A chance to join the Scouts?

女孩攥紧了胸前的怀表，仿佛要从中汲取决断的勇气。
She grasps the pocket watch tighter, as if to gain courage from it.

探知的线条隐约波动，又执着地向前伸出。一如施术者本人坚定的目光。
The light of her arcane skill shines as firmly as the caster's gaze.

小春雀儿：我需要——我需要比他们先找到泽维尔才行。
Eagle: I need to find Xavier before they do.

TO BE CONTINUED…
TO BE CONTINUED...

调查手册
An Investigator's Guidebook FX-03

调查手册
An Investigator's Guidebook

小春雀儿：……这周围都有神秘术波动。
Eagle: There are arcane skill fluctuations all around here.

属于神秘术的丝线触角波动着收回，小春雀儿谨慎地得出判断，对先前得到的信息愈发笃信。
It's unusual for there to be so many fluctuations out here in the suburbs.

偷听是不礼貌的，但此刻她别无他法。
The idea of a "secret mission" grows ever more convincing in her mind.

小春雀儿：也……也许“秘密任务”确实存在。这种地方不应该有这么密集的神秘术施术痕迹。
Eagle: "Secret mission" ... Maybe that's why there are so many fluctuations.

小春雀儿：他们刚才，难道就是被这个术法迷惑了吗？这……好像是某种神秘术道具。
Eagle: And that's why they keep walking in circles. There's some arcane skill—or maybe an arcane item—that's messing with them.

编外“童子军”陷入了苦思。
She murmurs to herself, her head tilted in thought.

小春雀儿：唔，无法确定……
Eagle: I can't be sure for now ...

探知的丝线又一次延伸了出去。
She decides to cast her arcane skill one more time.

不曾松懈的练习，理所当然的坚持。终于，她发现了童子军队伍以外的，生的气息。
She closes her eyes and concentrates hard. She senses a tiny spark of life.

一点意外惊喜。
She opens her eyes to find a small, fluffy surprise before her.

小春雀儿：嗯……嗯?
Eagle: Huh?

小狗：汪，汪！
Puppy: Woof! Woof!

小春雀儿：一只小狗？你在这里做什么呢?
Eagle: A puppy? What are you doing here?

小狗：嗷——呜汪！
Puppy: Woof, woof woof!

小狗亲密地拱着女孩的脚踝，做出了乞食的模样。
The puppy nuzzles her ankle and looks up at her, as if begging for food.

而小春雀儿摸遍全身，也只找到半袋补充体力用的饼干棒。
Eagle rummages in her pockets and pulls out a half-eaten granola bar.

小春雀儿：你饿了吗？你吃饼干吗？我可以分给你一些——
Eagle: You're hungry, aren't you? Do you want some of my granola bar? I can give you some.

小狗：汪！汪汪！
Puppy: Woof woof!

小春雀儿：好的，我掰给你。地面上有灰尘……你可以在我的手上吃。
Eagle: The ground's dirty. Just eat it from my hand. I'll break it up for you.

小春雀儿：来——哦。
Eagle: Here you are—Oh!

小狗儿风卷残云般消灭了女孩掌心的饼干碎，精神起来，转身就要跑走。
The puppy devours the bar, turns tail, and leaves.

小狗：嗷嗷！
Puppy: Woof woof!

小春雀儿：等等，那边没有——
Eagle: Wait, that's a dead end!

小春雀儿：路……呃?
Eagle: Huh?

小春雀儿：……至少，刚才确实没有。这是……这里有术法没有覆盖的缝隙?
Eagle: At least, it WAS a dead end ... Is there a gap here that the arcane skill doesn't cover?

小春雀儿：还是说这里是一个建筑盲点?
Eagle: Or maybe I just didn't spot it before.

小春雀儿：有可能，狗洞总是会出现在人们平视所注意不到的地方。
Eagle: It's probably just a blind spot. Dog holes are often hard to notice ...

小春雀儿：哦，这个拐角也位于我的右侧。不能忘记右手法则……
Eagle: Oh, this corner's on my right, so I can use the right-hand rule ...

小春雀儿：好像可以更顺畅地进行探查了。
Eagle: I'm glad I spent the time to learn that one now.

小狗：呜——
Puppy: *whine*

引路的小狗低声呜咽了几声，而后迅速地逃窜了，就像一颗突兀出现又消失的肥皂泡。
The puppy scampers away.

小春雀儿：咦……?
Eagle: Hmm?

小春雀儿踌躇不前。是活泼的狗儿，还是那个并不属于自己的任务?
She hesitates. What matters more? A puppy, or a mission that isn't hers?

小春雀儿：好吧……！先专注，找到泽维尔。
Eagle: Alright. Focus on the mission and find Xavier.

“神秘术的迷障绝不是完美的伪装，其中一定有漫不经心的破绽。”这是父亲教给她的。
As her father once taught her, "An arcane skill can never perfectly disguise something. There will always be a flaw."

更仔细的观察，更冷静的分析。
泥水，污渍，皮鞋踩过的小小水洼，小狗儿奔跑的足迹……
"Observe carefully, and you will find it." She scans the mud, the puddles, and the puppy's footprints.

小春雀儿：噢！脚印——
Eagle: Footprints!

她蹲下身来，搜寻可能存在的行人痕迹。
She cheerfully squats down, searching for other useful clues.

小春雀儿：唔……什么也没有……
Eagle: No other tracks around ...

小春雀儿：……
Eagle: ...

小春雀儿：外面有那种误导人的神秘术，父亲说过，他们能抹去存在的一切罪证。泽维尔说不定也擅长这个……
Eagle: Father said there are arcane skills that can remove all kinds of evidence. Maybe Xavier has this skill ...

小春雀儿：“当意识到这一可能性时，我们需要使用更有效的术法。当然，你得量力而行，孩子……”
Eagle: "If you're ever in a situation like that, use your arcane skill. But remember, don't push yourself too hard."

小春雀儿：再试试。
Eagle: I'll try again.

深呼吸后，她再次发动了神秘术。
For the third time, she casts her arcane skill.

《童子军手册》素养篇 V：谦虚谨慎，理性假设。
Scout Manual, Essential Virtues, Article V: "Be humble and prudent. Make rational assumptions."

???：进展报告。进展，百分之十……
???: Progress report: 10%.

此处当然略去所有不必提及的小型事故。
No need to mention those trivial accidents.

???: 呃，麻烦不要倒下来，不要倒——哇啊！！
???: Oh no. Don't fall, don't fall, don't—WHOA!

???: 好吧，第十四次清洁装置构架失败，空地不足，悬挂设施承重不足。
???: Well, there goes attempt number 14. Building the purification equipment has yet again ended in failure. There's not enough space, and the wires buckled under the weight.

???: 但在重来之前……先让我看看污染量化结果……
???: Let me check the pollution rate before I try again ...

???: 唔哦。看上去就算把整个工厂都用烟雾处理器和废水净化球填掉，也几乎完全没用。
???: Uh-oh. Even if I started the purification process when I was born, I wouldn't see much improvement in the pollution levels using this equipment.

???: 真有趣。那为什么还要用这种装置呢？这种简单精确，但对要达成的目标毫无助益的设计，是否算一种——反向戈德堡装置？
???: Then, why would someone use it? It's simple, yes, but completely useless—like the total opposite of a Goldberg machine!

???: ……好吧，也可能他们只是拿错了东西。
???: Or maybe they just gave me the wrong equipment.

???: 哈哈，这没法解决问题。难道我不是来解决问题的吗？
???: Regardless, it doesn't help me with my problem.

???: 我是来解决问题的。
???: And I'm here to solve problems, not create new ones.

???: 好吧……让我们来看看这个号称拉普拉斯最新款的宝贝。
???: Right, let's take a closer look at this "latest advancement in Laplace equipment."

???: 哦！你有个不错的轴承。可以用。
???: Oh, you have a nice bearing. I'll just "borrow" that ...

???: 现在，还有时间——
???: Now we're talking.

???: 还有时间“拯救”一下这个地方。
???: There's still time to save this place.

小春雀儿: ……？
Eagle: ...?

小春雀儿: 嗯——！
Eagle: Oh ...!

她的呼吸急促了起来。
Her breath quickens.

小春雀儿: 我好像找到了什么！
Eagle: I think I've found something!

工厂内部，生命共振的位置与施术痕迹大量地重叠。
The markings of an arcane skill. She follows them into the factory.

探知范围逐渐收拢，最终自动地汇集于一处，像磁石吸引四散的铁针。
She gradually narrows the search as the traces converge to a single location, as if magnetized to it.

“磁石”的中心，则被毫不遮掩的神秘学气息包裹。
This spot doesn't seem to be concealed at all.

小春雀儿：是有人使用神秘术的气息，向北，中心第 11 根横梁侧后方。
Eagle: The fluctuation of an arcane skill. North, behind the 11th pillar from the center.

小春雀儿：我找到了！
Eagle: I found it!

???：再这么等下去，太阳下山之前，我大概就用不上防毒面具了。
???: I hate to say this, but if you don't make it here by sunset, the gas mask will be useless to me.

接线员：抱歉，拉普拉斯的援助人员正在赶往你所在位置的途中，请耐心等待。
Operator: My apologies. The Laplace staff member is on the way. We appreciate your patience.

???：……
???: ...

属于通讯器的电流声回荡在空旷无人的工厂内。
He sighs. For a moment, he wants to hang up, but he stops himself.

???：“任务报告：主体首先失去嗅觉。大约一个小时后，陷入假性窒息。”如果运气好，我在晕过去之前不会吃太多苦头。
???: Progress report: I am now suffering from anosmia and will suffocate in one hour.

???：虽然现在似乎才刚到第一步。
???: If I'm lucky, I'll feel little pain before I lose consciousness.

???：说真的——你们要不要先确认一下，那些援助人员有没有被自己人设置的迷障网拦住？
???: Seriously, have you thought to confirm whether the staff have been kept out by your own Maze Net?

???：哦，这就挂断了。
???: Hello? Huh. They've already hung up.

???：那么，我就把这当作是对我自行其是的默认啦！
???: Well, I'll take that as my "get-out-of-jail-free card" to do whatever I want here!

???：如果真是被拦在外边了，那拉普拉斯岂不是做出了一件无法被破解，或者说，无法对其进行逆向工程的道具。
???: Since no one's here yet, does this mean they've invented a truly impenetrable protective tool?

???：简直是梦寐以求的安全性，提前至少三十年的技术创新。
???: If it can't be broken by their own people, then surely it can't be broken by anyone. Absolute safety—what an invention!

???：……
???: ...

???：虽然其他人不来确实更方便——
???: Anyway, maybe it's better they don't come. I can already see them denying my genius suggestions.

???：“意见驳回，请按照规章办事”。
???: "Suggestion rejected. Please follow the rules."

???：规章驳回，请自由发挥～
???: And I'll say, "Rejection rejected! Please improvise!"

???：在能自由发挥的情况下，多个跑腿的人也不坏。
???: Then again, if I AM going to improvise, an assistant would be helpful.

???：嗯——差不多了。不过总觉得还缺少了一点更加无与伦比的东西。
???: Alright, almost there. But I still feel like there's something missing ...

???: 是缺了什么呢……
???: Hmm ... What could it be?

小春雀儿: 呼……呼……
Eagle: *panting*

小春雀儿: 请问……
Eagle: Excuse me ...

???: 缺了……嗯，嗯?
???: Maybe ... Hm? Who's that?

小春雀儿: 请问，你是泽维尔吗?
Eagle: Sorry to interrupt. Are you Xavier?

TO BE CONTINUED…
TO BE CONTINUED...

握手，交换
Giving A Hand FX-04

握手，交换
Giving A Hand

X: ……
X: ...

小春雀儿: ……
Eagle: ...

次比年轻的不同脸孔，如出一辙的面面相觑。
The two youngsters stare at each other in stunned silence.

此刻，对峙氛围不足，迷惑情绪有余。显然提问是比动手更合适的选择。
They see confusion in each other's eyes.

小春雀儿: ……请问……
Eagle: Um ...

X: 这儿怎么会有小孩?
X: A kid? Here?

X: ……不对，你是怎么进来的?
X: Wait, how did you get in?

“答非所问”也是一种常见的安全选择。
Eagle recalls another article in the Scout Manual.

《童子军手册》安全篇 IX：与陌生人初次对话，应避免过快交换关键信息。
Scout Manual, Safety, Article IX: "Avoid giving out personal information to strangers."

小春雀儿: ……你看上去，年龄也不算大呀。
Eagle: You hardly look like an adult yourself ...

“泽维尔”突然变换了神色。他笑起来，看上去完全理解了一切。
To her surprise, "Xavier" smiles.

X: 我明白了。你是来找我的吧?
X: I see what's going on here.

小春雀儿：你知道……？
Eagle: You do?

X：当然。因为你没有指着我然后尖叫，“这里怎么有一根会动的香蕉！”。
X: Of course. You're here for me, right? Otherwise, you would've screamed, "A moving banana!" or something.

小春雀儿：香蕉？为什么？
Eagle: Banana? What are you talking about?

X：香蕉、橙子，或者别的什么。我记得那个迷障网会让强行穿越的人产生认知错乱，以为自己是某种水果。水果嘛，没有四肢，也就不会继续前进了。
X: Banana, orange, something like that. The Maze Net warps any trespasser's cognition, making them think of themselves and others as fruits. It stops them from moving any closer, since fruits don't have limbs.

X：总之，恭喜你穿过了迷障网，并且还是个正常神秘学家。
X: Anyway, congratulations on passing through the Maze Net with your sanity still intact!

X：好吧，人类标准的正常……或者别的。这也能证明你是他们送来的帮手？
虽然迟了点……
X: At least I think it's still intact ... So you're the staff member they sent?

X：不过刚好能帮上忙。
X: Better late than never. Come, I could use your help.

小春雀儿：好的，那……
Eagle: Okay, then ...

小春雀儿抬起头望着眼前空地上的不明设施，眼神里装满了敬畏。
She looks up at the gigantic equipment in amazement.

蓬勃的好奇让她很快就把要问的话忘得一干二净。
Her curiosity quickly eclipses the question she intended to ask.

小春雀儿：这是……什么？这就是你的“秘密任务”吗？
Eagle: Wow, what is this ... thing? Is this your "secret mission"?

X：嗯？算是吧。这是我的任务，可能也有那么点非公开性质。所以没错？
X: Mission, yes. Secret? Maybe. It's ... off-the-record, if you know what I mean.

X：如你所见，我正准备因地制宜地完成它～
X: As you can see, I'm performing this mission according to what this place really needs.

小春雀儿：它看起来……
Eagle: It looks ...

X：很壮观，还是很棒？我认为都是。不过还差了点东西，我正在想办法。
X: Spectacular? Magnificent? Go ahead. You can say both. But there's something missing, and I'm still trying to figure out what it is.

X：话说回来，你怎么没穿，呃，制服？
X: By the way, why aren't you wearing a uniform?

一个无心的问题。
A question asked with no ill intentions still stings her.

尽管无心，却仍使女孩下意识抓紧了胸前的怀表，让冷硬的金属表面硌进掌心。
Eagle subconsciously tightens her grip on her pocket watch.

承认这一点很难，小春雀儿知道。
It's hard to tell the truth to a stranger.

可诚实以待，对她来说也并非一种随时可变的选择。
But a Scout should always be honest—she doesn't have a choice.

小春雀儿：我……我还不是正式的……
Eagle: I-I'm not an ...

小春雀儿：……不是正式的成员。
Eagle: ... An official member.

X：哦，一个实习生。
X: Oh, so you're an intern.

X：没关系。也许在这之后，他们就会让你成为正式的编制成员呢?
X: It's okay. Maybe they'll make you a full-fledged member after this.

X：穿上白色的外套，变成一条聪明听话的——
X: Don the white uniform and become a loyal—

小春雀儿：什么……?
Eagle: A loyal what?

X：算了，不重要。我知道了缺点儿什么了，来，这儿，给我搭把手。
X: Never mind. Oh, I've figured out what's missing! Come give me a hand.

小春雀儿：我们……
Eagle: Sorry ...

X：怎么了？你难道不是来帮我的?
X: What's wrong? Aren't you here to help?

小春雀儿：严格来说，我是来带你回去的，泽维尔先生。
Eagle: Actually, I'm here to take you back, Mr. Xavier.

X：……好吧。你也确实没带着防毒面罩。至于“泽维尔”——
X: ... Makes sense, since you don't have any gas masks with you.

X：还是算了。你直接叫我“X”吧。
X: And just call me "X."

小春雀儿：抱、抱歉。我的信息，掌握得还不够全面。
Eagle: I-I'm sorry. I didn't have that information.

X：你们来之前，没有看过任务详情吗?
X: Didn't you check the mission briefing before you came here?

小春雀儿：其他人还在找你。我和、我和他们走散了。
Eagle: The others have it, but I ... got separated from them.

X：他们带了防毒面罩吗?
X: Do they have the gas masks?

小春雀儿：防毒面罩？那是什么?
Eagle: Gas masks? What's a gas mask?

小春雀儿：抱歉，可能因为我得到的信息有限，所以不清楚……
Eagle: Sorry, I should've collected more information ...

X：……?
X: ...?

小春雀儿：对不起！如果你实在需要这个“防毒面罩”，我现在就去帮你找。
Eagle: Sir, if you really need this "gas mask," I'll go find it for you.

眼前的协助者可能正来自于当下的时代，防毒面罩则是一个对她来说尚不存在的词汇。
X looks puzzled. How could she not know what a gas mask is?

虽然不清楚为什么会出现这样的纰漏，但年长的孩子选择了轻轻放过。
Perhaps this assistant is from this era, before they became widely used.

X：咳——忘了它吧，我们眼下有更重要的任务，之后可不见得有这么好的机会了。
X: Forget it. We've got more important things to do. I don't want to miss this opportunity.

X：要知道，那帮老古董们向来不太乐意接纳新玩意儿～
X: You know, those old fogeys are never willing to embrace new ideas.

小春雀儿：是的，您说得对……我有更重要的任务。
Eagle: You're right. There are more important things to do.

小春雀儿深吸了一口气。显然，她也并不想错过这份难得的机会。
Eagle takes a deep breath. She doesn't want to miss this chance.

她坚定地抬起头来。
She raises her head and stares at X with a firm look.

小春雀儿：先生，请跟我回去。至于“防毒面罩”，我会在之后……
Eagle: Sir, please come with me. As for the "gas mask," I'll—

“啪嗒——！”
Whoosh!

一把不知从哪个倒霉设备上拆下来的魔精毛刷，轻轻地兀自漂浮起来。
Suddenly, a critter fur brush pulled from one of the machines shoots through the air ...

它平稳地向着小春雀儿飞去，停在她沾满烟尘黑迹的衣袖旁。
And makes its way straight for Eagle.

一摇摆，一晃动。绒毛从肩膀扫过袖口。所有的灰尘都从那上面消失。
It lands on her sleeve, gently sweeping off the dust that has gathered on it.

小春雀儿：这是……？
Eagle: What's going on ...?

X：别管那些条条框框了，能来到这儿，已经说明你比其他人要能干得多了……漂亮地搞定这个任务，我会向他们推荐你的。
X: Forget the rules and regulations. You passed through the Net, so I already know you're much more capable than the others. And if you help me finish this task, I'll give my recommendation. Deal?

像是从天而降的一根稻草。
What a surprising offer!

小春雀儿：推荐……
Eagle: Recommendation ...?

女孩紧紧地攥住了它。
She decides to seize this opportunity.

小春雀儿：请为我下达指令！
Eagle: Please, give me your command!

X：先帮我让这玩意儿站稳，正常运作，之后咱们再说别的问题。时间不等人，明白吗？
X: First, help me get this thing up and running, then we'll talk about what to do next. Clock's ticking, understand? We don't have much time.

小春雀儿：明白！
Eagle: Copy that!

TO BE CONTINUED…
TO BE CONTINUED...

直觉之必需
Listen To Your Gut FX-05

直觉之必需
Listen To Your Gut

化工厂中心的空地上，一个巨大的戈德堡装置已经几近完整。
With the help of Eagle, a massive Rube Goldberg machine begins to take shape.

水泥柱排列出一条幽深而空旷的黑暗，繁复的架构立足其间。
The intricate machinery expands into the depths of the plant, with a dizzying amount of complexity.

X：——和我预想的有一定差距，不过不会影响最后的效果。
X: Hmm, you know, it's not exactly what I had planned originally, but it shouldn't adversely affect the results.

小春雀儿：其实……有件事，我一直不太明白……
Eagle: Uh, speaking of, mister—I wanted to ask ...

小春雀儿：烟雾处理装置，会需要这么多——嗯——会爆炸的东西吗?
Eagle: Why does a smoke purification device need so many ... um ... explosives?

X：作为一个实习生，你的观察力相当敏锐～
X: You're impeccably perceptive for an intern.

男孩俏皮地眨眨眼，后退一步上下打量起已经接近完成的“杰作”来。
He blinks at her, and turns back to appreciate his masterpiece.

X：不过呢，这只都是一些相关成分而已。不用担心。
X: Don't worry about it, we're just recycling the base components from the explosives.

小春雀儿：那它现在是完成了吗？如果是完成了，我们就快点一起回去——
Eagle: So, are we done? Maybe we can go back as soon as—

X：但是这里的回路还需要调整一下。嗯，你说什么?
X: —just need to adjust the circuit here. Hmm? Sorry, what did you say?

小春雀儿：回去的事。
Eagle: Are we going back?

X：哦，回去！当然了。不回去的话我去哪儿呢。
X: Sure, sure. Where else could we go if not back?

X：我也不会忘了刚才说的话。你的推荐信，我都记着呢。
X: And of course, I won't forget about your recommendation letter when I get back.

小春雀儿：……！好的!!
Eagle: ...! Yes, sir! Thank you, sir!

X：嗯嗯，所以……
X: You're welcome, but before that ...

X：麻烦把从那边的“强力净化 3.0”上拆下来的开闭单元递给我。
X: Would you mind providing me with that unit we extracted from the "Purification Master 2.0."

小春雀儿：好的……
Eagle: Got it!

男孩重新蹲下，把零件拿在装置的低处比划。
Eagle hands him the unit. X kneels down, comparing it to the blank space on the machine.

X：不行。这个尺寸不对。
X: —that won't do. It's the size isn't compatible.

X：唉，这种时候还是需要拉普拉斯的“万能工具箱 5.0”。
X: This would be the optimal use-case for Laplace's "All-in-One Tool Kit 5.0."

X：如果你带来了那东西就好了。当然，现在我只是说说。
X: You didn't happen to bring one along, did you?

小春雀儿：拉普拉斯?
Eagle: Laplace?

X：嗯？怎么?
X: Hmm, what?

小春雀儿：……不，没什么！那不重要……
Eagle: Oh, nothing!

小春雀儿：我在想，如果我们回去太晚，你的父母会担心的。
Eagle: I was just thinking ... your parents are probably really worried about you. Maybe we should head back.

X：啊。
X: Ah—

话音落下，小春雀儿察觉到一瞬间的气氛变化，但她无从了解原因。
As soon as she finishes her sentence, there is a sharp turn in the mood between them.

面前的男孩重新站起来。身旁漂浮的物件，也随着操纵者身体转向而动。
X stands, turning to her with the device still in his palm.

他的眼睛像月牙一样弯起，表情却实在不像任何先前已知的笑脸。
His mouth curves into a smile, but it doesn't seem so friendly anymore.

X：如果是这件事，那可能反而是最不需要担心的。
X: It'd be better for you to not concern yourself too much with that.

小春雀儿：嗯？为什么?
Eagle: Why?

X：现在……能麻烦你去看看你的“同伴们”都走到哪里了吗?
X: Now, shouldn't you go check on your other compatriots?

X：我觉得他们已经迷路太久了。
X: They've been lost in that maze a bit too long.

小春雀儿：唔……
Eagle: Hmm ...

小春雀儿于刚才找到的缝隙附近徘徊，为她指明方向的小狗仍然不知所踪。
Eagle paces back and forth near the entrance to the seam, there's no sign of the puppy.

小春雀儿：缝隙越来越大了……那个神秘术道具的效果好像在逐渐消失。
Eagle: The seam is bigger ... I guess the Maze Net thing is fading.

小春雀儿：嗯，是的。但他们还没有发现这里。
Eagle: Good thing no one's noticed it yet.

小春雀儿：我只需要这一点时间……
Eagle: I need to hurry up before they come.

童子军们仍未发现这里。他们原地打转，仿佛科尼岛的旋转木马。
The boy scouts are still stuck in their merry-go-round, circling one another over and over.

这个发现使她稍微安心，又因放松而勾起一些针对前事的愧疚。
She nearly laughs at the sight, but is soon overwhelmed by a wave of guilt and awkwardness.

小春雀儿：……
Eagle: ...

小春雀儿：也许，泽维尔和他的父母，关系并不融洽。
Eagle: Maybe Xavier doesn't get along with his parents.

小春雀儿：也许有什么别的原因……
Eagle: Or maybe it's something else.

她攥紧了怀表，摩挲着上面金属光滑的表面。
She rubs her pocket watch; its metal shell is lined with scratches over a smooth surface.

小春雀儿：总之，我不该……不应该未经调查就自说自话。
Eagle: But no matter what, I shouldn't have spoken up like that.

小春雀儿：承认错误，及时道歉。这也是童子军素养的一部分。
Eagle: I should apologize. That is what a good scout has got to do.

小春雀儿：嗯。
Eagle: Right.

女孩回头望去，化工厂水泥浇筑的轮廓在不远处露出一角，并不如往常一样灰烟缭绕。
Eagle looks back at the top of the plant, determined.

小春雀儿：出来很久了。该回去了。
Eagle: I have to go back to Xavier.

X：哦！你回来了！
X: Hey, welcome back!

X：时间正好。看，它已经完成了。现在，我们只需要一个绝佳的观众席——
X: Perfect timing. We're all set, all we need now is the right vantage from which to enjoy it.

X：我认为烟囱里面就很不错。
X: This chimney should work.

小春雀儿：泽维尔先生，你怎么在那里！
Eagle: Mr. Xavier—

从小春雀儿的方向看过去，他的半个身子已经站在了“烟囱”里。
Half of his body is sunk into the chimney pipe.

X：我说过了，是“X”。
X: Again, call me "X."

小春雀儿：X 先生……
Eagle: Mr. X, be careful—

X：嘘，先别说话。让我们赶紧弄完，在回去的路上慢慢说。
X: Shh. Save your words for the way back. Come on, the spectacle is about to begin.

小春雀儿：但是——
Eagle: But—

X：你能自己上来吗?
X: Can you get up here on your own?

小春雀儿：可、可以！我马上来！
Eagle: Y-yes! Just need a second or two!

小春雀儿攀上水泥平台，顺利把自己也藏匿进去。尽管她并不明白即将会发生什么。
Completely unaware of what's to come, she climbs up the cement chimney and stands next to X.

《童子军手册》素养篇 Ⅷ：专注仔细，减少提问。
Scout Manual, Essential Virtues, Article VIII: "Ask less, act more."

X：站稳了吗?
X: Hold on to something.

小春雀儿：是的！
Eagle: Yes, sir!

X：好。那接下来——
X: Alright. Then—

X：让我们开始吧。
X: Let's get this show on the road.

TO BE CONTINUED…
TO BE CONTINUED...

万能解
An Explosive Answer FX-06

万能解
An Explosive Answer

建筑轰塌。烟雾，尘霾，四散开来。一场人工的地震。
The plant collapses in a catastrophic rumble, spewing up a cloud of dust.

《童子军手册》上找不到应对方法的灾难。她只能目睹一切发生，而后木讷地伫立。
There was nothing in the Scout Manual that accounted for a circumstance like this. Her mouth lies open and slack-jawed.

此刻纯然的旁观者也正是麻烦的制造者。
A synthetic earthquake—all to the "credit" of the maestro beside her.

X：咳，咳咳！
X: *cough*

X：虽然在意料之中，但亲眼看过，感觉还是非常的……壮观。
X: Even when you know what's coming, it still never ceases to amaze, am I right?

小春雀儿：……X 先生。
Eagle: Mr. X ...

X：嗯?
X: Yeah?

小春雀儿：我以为这是——我以为你说这是烟雾处理器。
Eagle: I thought ... I thought you said this was a smoke purification device.

X：没错啊。把产生工业雾霾的源头掐灭，难道不是更为有效的烟雾处理方式吗?
X: I did say that. What better way of purifying smoke is there than getting rid of it altogether?

小春雀儿： 可是、可是这不对……
Eagle: But ... it's not—

X： 我保证，朋友。这绝对没有任何问题。
X: I promise, kid, it's completely safe.

X： 在你来之前，已经有人对工厂进行了人员疏散。因此在这过程中没有任何人类或者神秘学家受到伤害。
X: Before you got here, we evacuated the plant, so neither humans nor arcanists were harmed.

小春雀儿： 那附近的魔精——
Eagle: And critters—

X： 也没有魔精受到伤害！
X: And none of them too!

X： 甚至……我觉得都不一定有人听到了动静。毕竟外面有迷障网，爆炸一气呵成，也足够干净利落。
X: No one will have even noticed. The Maze Net should prevent all the noise from leaking.

小春雀儿： 我、我不是在说这个，而且你说的那个迷障网——它已经失效了！
Eagle: But the Maze Net isn't working anymore! I came in through a seam in it!

X： 哦，但就算迷障网失效了也没关系。
X: Oh, alright. Well ... no big deal.

X： 就像你并不是拉普拉斯的实习生，也没什么关系。
X: Just like it's no big deal that you're not really an intern from Laplace.

小春雀儿： 什么……?!
Eagle: What ...?!

她的手，几乎将那块怀表攥得滚烫。仿若一块烧红的烙铁，隔着骨肉与胸腔猛烈地共振。
Her heartbeat shoots up, her grip tightening on her pocket watch so hard that the clasp pokes into her skin.

X： 你不是拉普拉斯的人，却找到了迷障网的破绽。听说他们为了迭代试验了几万次，应该没那么容易被破解。
X: Yeah, you're not from Laplace. Albeit, you've figured out some way in through the Maze Net. I'm impressed, Laplace technology isn't easily beat.

X： 我很好奇。你究竟是用什么东西追踪到这里的，硕鼠血吗?
X: I'm curious, though. How did you locate me here? Did you use some arcane gadgets?

小春雀儿： 不是！是我的神秘术……不对。那你——你到底，是不是泽维尔?
Eagle: No, just my arcane skill. Wait, who are you? Are you Xavier or not?

X： 我说过了，我是“X”。
X: I'm "X."

是的。眼前的少年重复过许多次，而她却固执地忽略了这些现在看来异常明显的痕迹。
The realization sets in, he never once accepted the name she labeled him with.

小春雀儿： ……是的，是的。你说过。
Eagle: Yes, right ... You did say that.

小春雀儿： 你说过……
Eagle: So, then you're "X" ...

越来越近的、吵嚷的人声突然盖过了真相揭露的恍然时刻。
A gaggle of quarreling boy scouts interrupts her revelation.

童子军 I： ——我就说了我有办法！
Boy Scout I: Told you I'd figure it out!

童子军 I： 等着吧，动静这么大，泽维尔肯定吓坏了，会自己跑出来的。
Boy Scout I: That crash was huge! Must have freaked out Xavier. So, he'll probably run out from there!

小春雀儿： ……
Eagle: ...

X： 看来，迷障网的确失效了。
X: Ah. The Maze Net has definitely failed then.

小春雀儿： 我——我还得去找真正的泽维尔。我先——
Eagle: I-I need to find the real Xavier. I—

童子军 I： 咦？你不是那个总缠着教官的人吗？他都告诉你一百次了，你不可能加入童子军的。
Boy Scout I: Hey! Aren't you the girl that was bothering our scout leader? Hasn't he told you like a hundred times already? Girls CAN'T join the scouts!

小春雀儿： ……我没有总缠着教官，而且也没有一百次。
Eagle: It wasn't a hundred times ...

童子军 I： 放弃吧，穿裙子是加入不了童子军的！
Boy Scout I: Why don't you give up already? Whoever heard of a scout in a skirt!

X： 关于这一点，我想苏格兰的童子军协会肯定有不同的意见……
X: I think the Scottish Scouts might hold a different opinion on that ...

童子军 I： 你又是谁？反正，反正华盛顿童子军协会是不会接受一个小姑娘的，你身上那块破布也离真正的绶带差得远呢！
Boy Scout I: Who are YOU? Don't tell me, because I don't care what they do there, here in Washington girls can't be scouts! Just look at that dumb old rag on her—not even close to a real sash!

小春雀儿： 请让开。
Eagle: Step aside, please.

童子军 II： 等等，这个废墟……
Boy Scout II: Wait a second, they were here when this place exploded!

童子军 I： 肯定是他们弄出来的，泽维尔说不定都被埋在里面了！弄丢搜救对象，你还想加入童子军？
Boy Scout I: It must be their fault! What if Xavier is buried down there! What if he's dead? Some scout you are!

童子军 I： 你这样的表现，甚至没有人会在欢迎会上和你交换手帕！
Boy Scout I: Yeah, even if you did get let in, we'd never swap scarves with you!

小春雀儿： 泽维尔没有——X 先生说没有产生伤亡！
Eagle: Xavier can't be ... Mr. X said no one was harmed!

童子军 I： 乔治他们怎么还没来，我就说这边肯定有收获。
Boy Scout I: Where's George? Are the rest of them still walking in circles?

小春雀儿： ……我要走了。请让一让。
Eagle: I'm leaving. Get out of the way, please.

童子军 I： 谁允许你走了？我们现在要彻底打消你的妄想！
Boy Scout I: Who says you can leave?

X： 不好意思。你们到底想做什么？
X: Sorry, why can't she leave?

童子军 II： 如果我们找不到泽维尔，那么作为可能破坏了现场的人，你们需要跟我们回去。
Boy Scout II: Because if we can't find Xavier, then we've got to take her in. It's probably her fault this place blew up!

小春雀儿： 我会找到泽维尔。
Eagle: I'm going to find Xavier.

童子军 I： 你怎么找？你什么都不知道。
Boy Scout I: Oh, yeah—How? You don't even know what he looks like!

男孩们示威似地向前走出几步，站到小春雀儿的面前，摆开要拦住她的架势。
The boys stand together blocking her way out.

尽管身量的差距并不显著，但对她来说，眼前的人身上穿着的、真正的童子军制服，比所有挑衅的话语与表情都更为刺眼。
She stops. The thought of barging right through them crosses her mind, but just looking at their uniforms makes her too bitter to start.

小春雀儿： ……如果他不在这里，就会在其他的地方。总之——
Eagle: If he's not here, then he's got to be somewhere else. No matter what, I—

X： 总之你会找到他。
X: You'll find him.

X： 现在这地方几乎一览无余了，你会找到泽维尔的。
X: Now there's no place for him to hide. You'll find him sooner or later.

X： 而且……知道吗？就算你没有找到，你也可以和我一起回拉普拉斯。
X: And you know what? Even if you don't, you can go back to Laplace with me.

X： 思虑过多的小孩总是想做些什么。而恰好，你的能力看上去能做的事还有更多。
X: I can tell you're a kid carrying a heavy burden, and kids like you always need to do something. Anything.

X： 想不想看看别的路怎么走?
X: So, want to find something that you can do?

小春雀儿望着他，似乎听不明白那些话。
Eagle stares at him blankly, unsure of what he really means.

半晌，她决定先解决当下，于是轻轻地摇头了。
She decides to focus on her current mission.

小春雀儿： ……不，谢谢你。我可以找到的，我可以用我的神秘——
Eagle: No, thank you, sir. I will find it on my own, with my arcane sk—

冲撞的思绪使想要证明自己的话滚到舌尖。
"Arcane skill." The moment she says it out loud, she'll have outed herself as an arcanist.

只需轻轻一推，一切为她所知的真相都将摊开在所有人的面前。而后，她也将离成为童子军的未来愈远。
She won't need to hide anything anymore, but then the possibility of ever joining the scouts will shoot right down to zero.

——如果她没有被一阵轻微的呜咽声打断。
Thankfully, a cheerful bark interrupts her words.

小狗： 呜……汪呜……
Puppy: Woof! Woof!

小狗亲切地蹭了蹭小春雀儿的裤腿，残留在毛发间的饼干碎屑落到了地上。
The missing puppy runs towards her, snuggling her feet like an old friend.

小春雀儿： 嗯？是你?
Eagle: Oh? It's you!

童子军 I： 咦？泽维尔？
Boy Scout I: Xavier? Is that you?

回答几人的，是一阵表达确认的犬类叫声。
The puppy barks back, as if confirming his identity.

“泽维尔”： 嗷！
"Xavier": Woof!

X： ……哦。
X: Oh.

TO BE CONTINUED…
TO BE CONTINUED...

小狗归家
The Puppy Comes Home FX-07

小狗归家
The Puppy Comes Home

“泽维尔”跌跌撞撞地朝着人群聚集的方向跑来，停在小春雀儿的脚边。
The moment Xavier touches Eagle's feet, the dim lines around him disappear.

脏污但温暖的绒毛一经接触皮肤，几缕淡色丝线便环绕着消失了。
He seems to notice it as well, chasing his tail as if looking for its invisible trace.

狗狗总是更聪明的那个。
Somehow puppies always manage to be the smartest in the room. Even when outdoors.

小春雀儿： 是你……
Eagle: It's you.

X： 看样子你见过它。我是觉得一开始还听到了几声狗叫——
X: Seems like he likes you. I thought I heard something barking before ...

X： 原来是这样。
X: And you proved me right.

童子军 I： 嘿！是我们找到了泽维尔，你别想冒领功劳！
Boy Scout I: Hey! We found Xavier! That reward is ours!

小春雀儿： 是它找到了我们。而不是我们任何一个人找到了它。
Eagle: You didn't find him. He found us.

童子军 I： 你说什么？
Boy Scout I: What did you say?

童子军 II： 先确认一下特征吧。棕色，卷鬃毛的小型犬，胸前的吊牌——
Boy Scout II: Let's see if he meets the description: brown, curly fur, tag on his collar ...

小春雀儿蹲下来，轻轻捧起那枚狗牌，才以拇指擦去了上面的灰尘。
Eagle gently grasps the dog's collar and wipes the dust from his tag.

小春雀儿： 原来你早就在这里。我真傻……
Eagle: Turns out you were here with me the whole time.

童子军 II： 吊牌上写着“X”。它名字的首字母。
Boy Scout II: ... It's got an "X" on it, X for Xavier.

X：真巧。
X: What a coincidence.

童子军 II：是它，没错了。
Boy Scout II: That's him alright.

“泽维尔”也适时地吠叫几声，似乎强调自己的身份。
Xavier answers with an upbeat woof.

童子军 II：好……现在我们，呃，我们要怎么把它弄回去?
Boy Scout II: So, how do we take him back?

童子军 I：让我来试试——
Boy Scout I: Let me try, Xavi—

“泽维尔”：汪！
"Xavier": WOOF!

童子军 I：嘿！它想咬我！
Boy Scout I: Hey! He snapped at me!

小春雀儿：童子军手册说过，面对可能应激的动物，不能直接伸手……
Eagle: The Scouts Manual clearly says never to reach for a distressed animal.

小春雀儿：我和你们一起回去吧。
Eagle: He seems to trust me, I can take him back with you.

童子军 I：你甚至都不是一个童子军，凭什么对我指指点点，还要跟我们一起回去?
Boy Scout I: You're not even a scout! Who says you can go with us?

X：因为很显然，泽维尔知道功劳究竟是谁的——
X: Because I don't think Xavier will go along with you little credit-stealing twerps.

X：对吧?
X: Am I right?

有着相似名字的两者对视。小狗煞有介事地点头，X 也微笑起来。
The puppy looks up affectionately at X. He smiles back.

X：而且，让她一起回去这件事不是你们自己要求的吗?
X: Also, weren't you just asking her to go back with you?

童子军 I：呃——
Boy Scout I: Um ...

小春雀儿：X 先生。
Eagle: Mr. X.

小春雀儿：那些正在走过来的人，是不是你的同伴？他们穿着和你很像的衣服。
Eagle: Are those people over there your partners? Their clothes are similar to yours.

X：什么——噢，见鬼。
X: What—OH, SHOOT.

面色不善的白衣服出现在视野尽头。他们从化工厂的方向朝此处快步走来，显然有些什么特别的理由。
Even before he can read their expressions, the look of the people approaching in white spells trouble for him.

X：……紧急情况。回头见！
X: That's ... an emergency. See you later!

小春雀儿：嗯？好的，再见。
Eagle: Hmm? Okay, Mr. X, see you.

童子军 II： 他……
Boy Scout II: What's going on with him?

小春雀儿： 我们也走吧。
Eagle: Dunno. Let's just go back.

教官： ……我明白了。
Scout Leader: I understand.

教官： 现在，你们几个，带上泽维尔去会客室。卡拉克夫人正在等着。
Scout Leader: Now, take Xavier out to Mrs. Clark. She's waiting for him.

童子军 I： 那她呢？她和她那个怪人朋友都把化工厂——
Boy Scout I: What about her? She and her weirdo friend blew up the—

教官： 先生们。我已经了解情况，不必复述。
Scout Leader: Scouts, you don't have to repeat it for me.

童子军 II： 走吧，马特。
Boy Scout II: Let's go, Matt.

童子军 I： ……你怎么也不帮我说话！
Boy Scout I: Whose side are you even on?

童子军 II： 我觉得，泽维尔也不想一直呆在笼子里，对吧？
Boy Scout II: I just think maybe Xavier will want to see his owner soon ...

男孩们小声嘟囔，七手八脚地提起装着小狗的笼子，离开了办公室。
The boys take the dog and leave.

过程中，小春雀儿没有转头。她全神贯注的目光，这回始终准确地放在眼前的大人身上。
The little disturbance doesn't distract Eagle. She stares intently at the scout leader, hanging on every word he might say.

此地，所有坐标的中轴线。所有问题的裁定者。
A simple distraction may lead to serious consequences. She has learned her lesson.

她如此坚定又怀揣忐忑地注视，几乎以为自己就要靠近那个愿望的实现。
As the leader looks at her, she straightens her back even more.

小春雀儿： 长官，我想加入童子军。
Eagle: Sir, I want to join the scouts.

教官： ……六个小时还改变不了女孩不能加入童子军这件事，孩子。
Scout Leader: Kid, it's not even been six hours since the last time I turned you down. I haven't changed my mind.

教官： 况且，现在其实没有人能证明是你找到了泽维尔。
Scout Leader: Besides, all I've got is your word that says you're the one that found Xavier.

小春雀儿绞紧双手。她告诫自己不要反复质疑长官的判断，但辩驳的话仍然脱口而出。
Eagle wrings her hands. Despite all the instructions in the Scout Manual to the contrary, she blurts out.

小春雀儿： 如果您不相信，又为什么要我留下来呢。
Eagle: If you don't trust me, why did you ask me to stay?

声音惶然而迷惑。她的确不明白。
There is a mix of pain and confusion in the question.

教官： 因为，虽然马特的确是个冒失鬼……
Scout Leader: Because I know Matt well.

教官： 但我不认为他会撒谎。
Scout Leader: He wouldn't make something like this up.

小春雀儿： 您相信……我?
Eagle: So, you believe me?

教官： 我倾向于认同他们的说法，是你和你的朋友在那里，既造成了那片废墟，也引出了失踪的小狗。
Scout Leader: I believe them. And what they told me is that factory crumbled to pieces and the noise is what brought Xavier out.

教官： 我了解到那片废墟不需要我们善后，那种程度的爆炸也并非你个人的能为。所以，如果你的这位朋友可以来到这里，为你作证……
Scout Leader: Now, Matt blamed you and your friend, but I can't see how two teenagers could take down a whole building, and anyway, he agreed you were the one that brought the dog back.

教官： 我会破例给你颁发一枚雏鹰勋章。
Scout Leader: So, against my better judgement, if your friend vouches for you, I'll give you the merit badge.

各有退让。条件已经被给出，此刻的小春雀儿却无法抓住这次机会。
A tempting offer. Her eyes glint, but the light soon fades.

她只能低下头去，紧紧抓住了胸前的怀表。
She doesn't even know where to find this so-called "friend."

小春雀儿： ……
Eagle: ...

教官： 怎么，他来不了吗?
Scout Leader: What, you don't think your friend will come?

她摩挲上面的划痕，一道、两道、三道……每一道都是对自己的鼓劲。
She clenches the pocket watch, rubbing the cover.

先前没能说完的证明终于脱口而出。
Its familiar scratches giving her the courage to speak.

小春雀儿： 我的、我的神秘术，长官。也能够证明……我可以展示给您看!
Eagle: I-I can vouch for myself, sir. I'll show you my a-arcane skill!

教官： ……神秘术?
Scout Leader: Arcane skill?

教官： 哈，神秘术。简直没有比这更“好”的证据了，不是吗?
Scout Leader: Of course, arcane skill. Like that's going to prove anything.

小春雀儿： 长官——
Eagle: Sir—

教官： 只有两个选择，固执的小姐。离开这里，带上你的朋友回来领取勋章，或者不再回来。
Scout Leader: Two choices, young lady. Either ask your friend to vouch for you and get the badge, or give up and don't come back.

教官： 以及，放弃你荒唐的神秘学言论。
Scout Leader: Either way, don't ever mention your arcane skill again.

教官： 不要浪费自己的时间了。
Scout Leader: Don't waste my time.

TO BE CONTINUED…
TO BE CONTINUED...

蝴蝶振翅之时
A Butterfly Flaps Its Wings FX-08

蝴蝶振翅之时
A Butterfly Flaps Its Wings

小春雀儿：……

Eagle: ...

公墓中，罕有人迹的一角，小春雀儿伫立于此。
Alone in the cemetery, Eagle stands in front of her father's tombstone.

面对一块仅余镌刻的无言石碑，无论曾经怎样动摇的情感，都会回归平静。仿若搁浅的鲸鱼被归还海洋一般的平静。
She hadn't been alone long, only a few moments ago a stranger had been there, leaving her with a troubled mind.

但波托马克河中实际没有鲸鱼。于是活人的心也将永远悬置。
It's already difficult enough to keep composed whenever she's here.

小春雀儿：“……这里到洛伦兹不算太远。”……

Eagle: Sorry to keep you waiting, dad.

小春雀儿：您听见了吗？刚才那个人说的话。

Eagle: Did you hear what he just said? "It isn't too far from Lorentz here."

她蹲下去，把捧花扶起来重新靠好，又站起来。同样的动作她已经重复无数次，仍然不厌其烦。
She crouches over and props up the flowers she brought. Petals from the last time are still caught in the creases of the stone.

这种耐心在同龄人中相当少见。
Loss makes you age beyond your years—it can't be helped. But maturity has its benefits.

小春雀儿：他说，他曾是您的同事。你们曾经一起工作，就像是朋友那样？

Eagle: He said he was your colleague. That you used to be friends.

小春雀儿：就像马特和他的朋友……

Eagle: Like Matt and his friends?

小春雀儿：可我还是不明白。

Eagle: But I don't really understand ...

小春雀儿：洛伦兹，或者拉普拉斯。那都是什么，是我应该去了解的吗？

Eagle: He mentioned Lorentz, and Laplace ... What was that all about? Should I know anything about them?

小春雀儿：如果我了解了，就能够这样踩着您留下的脚印前进吗？

Eagle: And if I do this, what does that mean? Am I following in your footsteps?

小春雀儿：我可以流畅地背出童子军手册，但是……

Eagle: I can memorize every word in The Scouts Manual, but ...

小春雀儿：我好像并不是一个值得您骄傲的孩子。

Eagle: But I'll never know if I made you proud.

几日前的“失败”出现在脑海中。小春雀儿晃了晃脑袋。
She shakes her head, trying to rid herself of that thought.

小春雀儿：好吧。前几天，我和母亲都还在布鲁克林的时候……我遇到了另一个人。

Eagle: A few days ago, back in Brooklyn, I met someone else.

小春雀儿：他……唔。刚才是不是已经说过这个了。
Eagle: He, um ... did I talk about it already?

小春雀儿：……
Eagle: ...

小春雀儿：他也问了我一个问题，当时我不知道怎么回答。
Eagle: He asked me a question, but I didn't answer. I didn't know how to answer—

小春雀儿：他问我，“想不想看看别的路怎么走?”。
Eagle: He asked me, "Want to find something that you can do?"

小春雀儿：和刚才那位先生说的话，很相似……
Eagle: Just like what Mr. X said to me.

小春雀儿：可我不知道，父亲。我还是不知道。
Eagle: I'm just confused, dad.

小春雀儿：但也许，也许我总会明白的，对不对?
Eagle: But maybe one day I'll understand, right?

她把绶带的陈旧布料捏在手中，抬起头，目光紧紧盯住眼前的墓碑。
Her gaze turned from the worn old sash in her hands back to the tombstone.

小春雀儿：一定是这样的。
Eagle: Right, I will.

下城区的街道上，小春雀儿匆匆穿行而过，将自己藏进灰砖墙与铁栅栏之间。
She's passing through alleys and over fences, swift as a breath of wind.

这是一条通往旅馆的最快捷路线。母女两人来到河的对岸探亲，她落脚之后的第一件事，就是摸清了周围街区环境和出行路线。
It'd been a few days since she and her mom came to visit her aunts. The first thing to do after settling in was to get the lay of the land.

为了保护自己，更为了保护母亲。对这些事她向来做得很好。
She's learned to do this well, anything to protect her mother and herself.

小春雀儿：拐过去，还有半个街区……
Eagle: Next corner turn right, and then half a block away ...

小春雀儿：……快点……得再快点——
Eagle: I need to hurry up ...

小春雀儿：回去。
Eagle: Or mom will get worried.

闪烁的思绪之间，她在隐约的人声中推开旅馆房门。放下的脚步也轻缓，又轻缓。
She leaps lightly into the room, without drawing any attention.

???: ……是更合适的去处。
???: ... would be a better place.

小春雀儿：我回来了——妈妈?
Eagle: Hi mom, I'm back—Mom?

X：噢，嗨。不是你妈妈，但，我们又见面啦～
X: Oh, hi. Not your mom, but welcome back!

小春雀儿：……!
Eagle: ...!

小春雀儿： X 先生！你怎么会在这里?
Eagle: Mr. X! Why are you here?

X： 我说了，“回头见”，记得吗?
X: I said see you later. Remember?

小春雀儿： 你——
Eagle: You—

母亲： 先进去换件衣服吧，孩子。你又在墓园呆得忘了时间，肩膀都被露水打湿了。下次，我说什么都要跟你一起去才行。
Mother: Oh, look at you, your shirt is all wet. Go change out of those clothes. Next time I'll go with you, so you don't get up to trouble.

小春雀儿： 对不起，妈妈……但有件事，我想问问您的意见……
Eagle: Sorry, mom, but there's something ... I need your advice.

母亲： 至少先去擦擦头发吧。
Mother: Alright, but we're drying your hair first.

小春雀儿： 妈妈，我今天在那里遇见了一个人……他说他曾经与父亲共事过。
Eagle: I met a man in the cemetery, and he said he worked with dad.

小春雀儿： 您会认识他吗?
Eagle: Do you think you might know him?

话语间，小春雀儿看向 X。短暂的视线相对之后，年长的男孩两指交替，在空中比划出一个简单的溜走动作。
She looks over to X as she talks to her mom. X makes a gesture to the door.

但女孩只是盯着，随即坚定地摇了摇头。
Eagle shakes her head disapprovingly.

母亲： 傻孩子，我不清楚他的模样，又要怎样确认呢？但他能认出你，也许真的是你父亲的老朋友。
Mother: It's possible, sweetie—especially if he recognized you. But, I couldn't say without seeing him myself.

母亲： 不过，你一个人外出，还是需要对陌生人提高警惕——
Mother: But please be careful talking to strangers ... especially with you're out there all alone.

小春雀儿： 他告诉我说，父亲曾经不仅仅隶属于军队。他还提到了一个叫洛伦兹的地方……
Eagle: He told me, father wasn't just in the military, but also a member of "Lorentz."

小春雀儿： 虽然我不知道那是哪里，但……我是不是也不一定要成为童子军?
Eagle: I don't know what that is, but if dad worked there, then maybe ... I can join them instead of the scouts?

母亲： 孩子，我对你唯一的期望就是健康和快乐。
Mother: Sweetheart, all I ever wanted is for you to be healthy and happy.

母亲： 我会支持你的所有决定。
Mother: You can join the scouts or Lorentz, or anything! I will support you, no matter what.

X： 嗯？虽然不知道你今天还遇见了谁，但听上去像是我的同事。
X: Hmm? That sounds like one of my colleagues.

X： 不过这都不重要，你可以将我的建议当作那个话题的延伸。
X: Take this question as the continuation of that conversation.

X： ——要不要和我一起回拉普拉斯?
X: Would you like to join Laplace with me?

小春雀儿：我不知道……拉普拉斯，和洛伦兹，它们都是什么。
Eagle: I ... I don't know what Laplace and Lorentz are.

小春雀儿：你们能接受女孩的加入吗？那位先生和你，看上去都是男孩……
Eagle: But are girls allowed to join?

X：哦，我们可没有那么多的条条框框，就算你不是女孩，也不是男孩，甚至都没什么所谓——
X: Oh, we don't care about any of that. You can join us even if you're neither a boy nor a girl.

X：扯远了，总之你可以简单把它们当成同一个地方的不同组织。如果你愿意，我可以之后再更详细地为你介绍一下。
X: But that's really beside the point. As far as you are concerned, Laplace and Lorentz are two different organizations, but we share an office. It's not far from here actually. I can give you a more detailed introduction if you like.

小春雀儿：……但父亲不在了，我应该更照顾母亲。我不能一直留在这里。
Eagle: But my dad is gone. I need to take care of my mom. Besides, we don't live here, so I can't stay long.

X：但你的母亲说，你们已经在为搬过来做准备了。
X: Hmm, but your mom just told me you're moving.

小春雀儿：什么？
Eagle: Is that true?

母亲：我想离你的父亲，也和我的姐妹们更近点。虽然我还是无法直面那个墓碑——
Mother: Well, your aunties are here, and I want to be closer to your father.

母亲：但总有一天我会的。
Mother: Though I still can't bear to go there, but I will one day.

小春雀儿：……
Eagle: ...

小春雀儿：但是……为什么是我？我不出众，也不能完美地完成任务……
Eagle: But, why me? I didn't really help all that much.

X：我没有说过吗？你是一个很称职的助手。
X: Nah, you were a perfect assistant. Remember, you helped me with that equipment, or was that someone else?

X：并且你之前还成功找到了“X”，不管是哪个。这说明你有很敏锐的观察和搜寻能力。
X: Besides, you successfully found "X," both of us, which showed your acute observation skills and capability under pressure.

X：综上所述，我认为你的素质远超那群过家家的童子军，需要一个远比童子军协会更有意思、更适合你的地方。
X: All in all, I think you'd be wasted on the scouts, you deserve to shine bright, not waste your time collecting tin badges.

小春雀儿：——？
Eagle: I-I do?

X：所以……
X: You heard me.

X：我带来了另一条路。
X: And I'm here to show you another way.

小春雀儿：啊，这是……
Eagle: This is ...

小春雀儿：一件制服……和你的很相似——
Eagle: A uniform, it's a little like yours!

小春雀儿：这是一件真正的制服?
Eagle: Is this an official uniform?

X：是啊。这就是“另一条路”。
X: Yes, and this is the other way I'm offering you.

X：这是洛伦兹研究所的制服。
X: The way to the Institutum Lorentz.

小春雀儿：洛伦兹，另一条路……
Eagle: Lorentz. Another way ...

X：没错。
X: That's right.

X：毕竟，我认为……
X: Because after that mission ...

X：你应该寻找的不是一只小狗，而是一只蝴蝶。
X: I think you shouldn't be looking for a puppy, but a butterfly.

THE END
THE END